

MICAH OEVERMANN

Texas A&M University ◊ College Station, Texas ◊ U.S. Citizen

mjoovermann@gmail.com ◊ (281) 925-9569

micah-oevermann.com

EDUCATION

PhD in Mechanical Engineering

December 2025

Texas A&M University, College Station, USA

Dissertation Title: Design, Modeling, and Nutational Instabilities of Soft Pendulum Driven Spherical Robots

B.S. in Mechanical Engineering

December 2021

Texas A&M University, College Station, USA

Study Abroad - Engineering Mechanics

Summer 2019

Arts et Métiers ParisTech, Aix-en-Provence, France

EXPERIENCE

Robotics and Automation Design Lab

January 2022 - Present

Graduate Research Assistant

College Station, TX

- Led a small team of grad students and engineers on the full-stack development of the RoboBall II prototypes from CAD to concrete
- pioneered a novel outer shell manufacturing design, control, and pydrake simulation environments for RoboBall
- led teams of 5, 3, and 2 undergraduates in the three summer programs, all resulting in conference or journal publications
- collaborated with the Robotic Space Simulator team on the motion control two 7-dof Stewart platforms with UR-20 arms
- Collaborated with external partners at Southwest Research Institute for the development of motion planning libraries

BakerRisk Engineering Consultants

August 2020 - December 2020

Student Co-op, Blast Testing Group

San Antonio, TX

- Instrumented destructive full-scale structural testing with Deflagration, Vapor Cloud, and Shock Tube methods
- Manufactured mounts for window specimens and piezoelectric pressure or force instrumentation
- Prioritized safety with no major injuries while working around debris fields

Biomechanical Environments Laboratory (BMEL)

January 2019 - May 2019

Undergrad Research Assistant

College Station, TX

- Applied concepts of linear elastic theory in the development of a biaxial tissue testing platform
- Implemented the use of a novel fish hook – line technique on organic samples to reduce clamp stresses
- Presented final design on a poster in a public research symposium

TEACHING AND COUNSELING EXPERIENCE

Guest Speaker - MEEN 612

December 2024

Introduction to Robotic Manipulators

College Station, TX

- Lecture Title: *Introduction to Simulating Robot Arms in pyDrake*

Guest Speaker - MEEN 689

December 2024

Intuitive and Counterintuitive Mechanisms

College Station, TX

- Lecture Title: *Designing for Assembly: Lessons from RoboBall II Pendulum*

Grad Camp Counselor

Fall 2022

Graduate Orientation Camp

College Station, TX

- Assist incoming graduate students at introductory sessions to the university

Numerical Methods Helpdesk

August 2019 - December 2019

Student Worker for MEEN 357

College Station, TX

- Assist students with Python code portions of projects and homework

Volunteer Teaching Assistant

August 2018 - December 2018

Kinesiology 199 - Whitewater Kayaking

College Station, TX

- provided one-on-one instruction and feedback of basic paddling techniques

Python Teaching Assistant

August 2018 - December 2018

Student Assistant for Intro Engineering Course ENGR 102

College Station, TX

- Assisted in the instruction of freshman engineering students with the basics of coding in python

FUNDING AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Lou & CC Burton '42 Scholarship ◊ \$10,000

Awarded 2020-2021

Lechner Scholarship ◊ \$10,000

Awarded 2017-2020

CITGO Petroleum Corp. Scholarship

Awarded 2018-2019

Pat Wilburn Honorary Scholarship

Awarded 2017-2019

HONORS AND AWARDS

Best Presentation Award

September 2023

OSU International Mechatronics Conference and Exposition, 2023

Senior Capstone: Best in MEEN

December 2021

Texas A&M University, College Station, USA

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

Empirical Contact Models for Soft Spherical Robots in Drake

Oevermann, Micah J., Dhruv Datta, Dylan Hilburn, Derek J. Pravecek, Rishi Jangale, Aaron Villanueva, and Robert O. Ambrose

IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (2025). 2025

Empirically Compensated Setpoint Tracking for Spherical Robots With Pressurized Soft-Shells

Pravecek, Derek J, **Micah J Oevermann**, Gray C Thomas, and Robert O Ambrose

IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (2025). 2025

Peer Reviewed Conference Papers

Scaling of RoboBall: A Parametric Robot Family for Crater Exploration

Jangale, Rishi V, Aaron Villanueva, Garrett Jibrail, **Micah J Oevermann**, Derek J Pravecek, Meghali P Dravid, and Robert O Ambrose

2025 IEEE Aerospace Conference, 2025

A Pressure Model and Control System for a Pressurized Pendulum Driven Spherical Robot

Micah J Oevermann, Meghali P Dravid, Derek J Pravecek, Will Olejnik, and Robert O Ambrose

2025 22nd International Conference on Ubiquitous Robots (UR), 2025

Design of a Soft Shell for a Spherical Exploration Robot Traversing Varying Terrain

Dravid, Meghali Prashant, **Micah Oevermann**, David McDougall, David Dugas, and Robert Ambrose
2024 IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2024

A Soft Spherical Robot for Lunar Crater Exploration

Micah Oevermann, Meghali Prashant Dravid, Garrett Jibrail, Jared Janak, Rishi Jangale, David McDougall, David Dugas, and Robert O Ambrose
AIAA SCITECH 2024 Forum, 1961, 2024, 2024

Roboball: An all-terrain spherical robot with a pressurized shell

Micah Oevermann, Derek Pravecek, Garrett Jibrail, Rishi Jangale, and Robert O Ambrose
2024 IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA), 2024

Presented Abstracts

A System for Exploring Craters and Shadowed Regions of the Lunar South Pole

Dravid, Meghali, **Micah Oevermann**, and Robert Ambrose
ASCE Space and Earth Conference, 2024

RoboBall Recap: Past, Current, and Future Inflatable Spherical Robots

Jangale, Rishi, **Micah Oevermann**, Garrett Jibrail, Derek Pravecek, Meghali Dravid, Aaron Villanueva, and Robert Ambrose
40th Anniversary of the IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation, 2024

Persistent intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance for the Lunar Surface

Ambrose, Robert, **Micah Oevermann**, Meghali Dravid, and Garrett Jibrail
AIAA ASCEND Conference, 2023

Design and Dynamics of Rugged Soft Shells for a Pendulum-Driven Spherical Robot

Micah Oevermann, Meghali Dravid, Garrett Jibrail, and Robert Ambrose
OSU International Mechatronics Conference and Exposition, 2023

Works Under Review

Relaxation Dynamics in Oblate Spherical Rolling Robots

Oevermann, Micah J. and Robert O. Ambrose
Proceedings of the IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA) (2026). 2026

Derivation and Control of Coupled 3D Dynamics for Fast Locomotion in 2-DOF Pendulum-Driven Spherical Robots

Pravecek, Derek, Rishi Jangale, **Oevermann, Micah**, Aaron Villanueva, Joeseeph Garrett Jibrail, and Robert O. Ambrose
IEEE Transactions on Robotics (2026). 2026

Novel Robotic Fleet for Sample Recovery in Lunar Craters: A Concept of Operations

Jangale, R., D. Pravecek, S. Lam, D. McDougall, M. Treviño IV, A. Villanueva, J. Land, H. De Leon, **Oevermann, M.**, and R. Ambrose
IEEE Transactions on Field Robotics (2025). 2025